MODULE 00 · FOUNDATIONS AND EXAM SKILLS - ALL DOMAINS

AI-103: the complete course

Nine hours forty-six minutes, weighted like the exam. 144 worked scenarios, three practice exams, and every fact checked against Microsoft's documentation.

DOMAIN Start here WEIGHT - MODULE 00 of 39

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The exam tests **decisions**, not definitions. So this course is built from **scenarios** and the questions that settle them.

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What you're sitting

FACT	DETAIL
Exam	AI-103: Developing AI Apps and Agents on Azure
Replaced	AI-102, which retired on 30 June 2026
Appointment	Plan for 120 minutes: about 100 answering
Questions	Most Microsoft exams have 35 to 50
Pass mark	700, on a scaled score of 1 to 1,000
Code	Python only

ON THE EXAM

Microsoft Learn is available during this exam. Module 36 covers how to use it without losing time.

The five domains, and this course's time

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	COURSE TIME
1 - Plan and manage an Azure AI solution	28%	2h 03m
2 - Generative AI and agentic solutions	33%	2h 32m
3 - Computer vision solutions	13%	1h 01m
4 - Text analysis solutions	13%	1h 03m
5 - Information extraction solutions	13%	59m

ON THE EXAM

Teaching time matches the published weights within about a point per domain. Study time should follow the same shape.

How the course is built

- **32 domain modules**, following the study guide's skills in order.
- **4 exam skills modules**: old versus new answers, confusion pairs, reading code, mechanics.
- **3 practice exams**: 60 questions, domain-weighted, no topic repeated.
- **144 worked scenarios**, four in every teaching module.
- Every fact checked against Microsoft's documentation, with the date it was checked.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> About a quarter of exam questions carry code, so Python appears throughout, and module 35 is devoted to reading it.

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The same shape every time

01
Core idea
One sentence that frames everything.

02
Teach
Tables, comparisons, honest limits.

03
Code
Real SDK calls, read line by line.

04
Decide
Four scenarios, with a pause.

05
Worked
Why each option wins or loses.

06
Carry forward
Five lines to remember.

ON THE EXAM

Slides marked 'Honest limits' cover what a service can't do, or is retiring. Examiners like those details.

When a scenario appears, **pause and commit**. The mark is in the deciding, not in the reading.

Things that retired while this course was written

- **DALL-E 3** retired 4 March 2026, and the original **Sora** on 28 February 2026.
- **QnA Maker** and **LUIS** are gone; **Computer Vision APIs 1.0 to 3.1** retired 13 September 2026.
- The **Connected Agents** tool doesn't exist in the current Agent Service.
- Content Understanding's **pro mode** lived only in a preview API that retired 15 July 2026.
- Older practice material still names all of these. Module 33 translates them.

> ON THE EXAM
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> An answer naming a retired product is always wrong, however well it once worked.

Things retiring soon after it

- **Azure OpenAI On Your Data:** 14 October 2026. **Sora 2 preview:** 15 October 2026.
- **Foundry workflows** and the visual designer: 1 December 2026.
- **Agents (classic)**, with threads and runs: 31 March 2027. **Prompt flow:** 20 April 2027.
- **Custom Vision** and **Image Analysis:** 25 September 2028.
- **Azure Language legacy features**, including key phrases and sentiment: 31 March 2029.

> HONEST LIMITS
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> Check these dates the week you sit the exam. Two of them fall within weeks of this recording.

Domain 1 - Plan and manage (2h 03m)

STARTS	MODULE
0:00	01 - The Foundry mental model
13:45	02 - Choosing a model
25:54	03 - Choosing the service
38:30	04 - Infrastructure and deployment options
50:38	05 - CI/CD for Foundry projects
1:01:51	06 - Quotas, rate limits, scaling and cost
1:13:53	07 - Securing AI systems
1:26:48	08 - Monitoring models and retrieval

ON THE EXAM

Start here even if you're experienced: modules 01 to 04 set up the vocabulary every later module uses.

Domain 1 ends, Domain 2 begins (2h 32m)

STARTS	MODULE
1:39:11	09 - Guardrails and content safety
1:50:17	10 - Responsible AI instrumentation and governance
2:02:57	11 - Connecting an app to Foundry
2:17:38	12 - Tuning generation
2:32:35	13 - RAG in an application
2:47:04	14 - Workflows and multistep reasoning
3:02:16	15 - Evaluating models and apps
3:17:58	16 - Observability

ON THE EXAM

Domain 2 is the largest on the exam, at 33%. It runs from module 11 to module 20.

Agents, then Domain 3 (1h 01m)

STARTS	MODULE
3:33:04	17 - Agents I: design
3:48:30	18 - Agents II: tools and memory
4:04:49	19 - Agents III: multi-agent orchestration
4:19:35	20 - Agents IV: autonomy with safeguards
4:35:01	21 - Generating and editing images
4:49:24	22 - Generating and editing video
5:03:46	23 - Multimodal understanding
5:20:50	24 - Responsible AI for visual content

ON THE EXAM

Four modules on agents, because agents are where the exam's newest material lives.

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Domains 4 and 5 (2h 02m)

STARTS	MODULE
5:35:46	25 - Extracting meaning from text
5:51:45	26 - Sentiment, sensitive content, customisation
6:08:04	27 - Translation
6:22:14	28 - Speech for agents
6:38:52	29 - Ingesting and indexing for grounding
6:53:54	30 - Enrichment with skills
7:08:21	31 - Semantic, hybrid and vector search
7:23:06	32 - Content Understanding and document extraction

ON THE EXAM

Domains 4 and 5 changed most in 2026: Azure Language's legacy split, and Translator's new API.

Exam skills and practice exams (2h 08m)

STARTS	MODULE
7:37:53	33 - From AI-102 answers to AI-103 answers
7:50:25	34 - Confusion pairs
8:04:52	35 - Reading Foundry Python code
8:17:06	36 - Exam mechanics
8:29:17	37 - Practice exam 1
8:54:13	38 - Practice exam 2
9:19:39	39 - Practice exam 3

> ON THE EXAM
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> If you're short of time, modules 33 to 36 are the highest return per minute in the course.

Three ways to work through it

- **Full run:** modules 01 to 36 in order, then a practice exam a day for three days.
- **Experienced on Azure:** start at module 33, then fill the domains your paper scores expose.
- **Short of time:** modules 33 to 36, all three papers, then the weakest domain.
- After each paper, compare **domain profiles**, not totals.
- A domain that's weak in two papers is where the remaining time goes.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Sixty practice questions is a sample, not a guarantee. The modules are where the knowledge lives.

Where Microsoft's documentation is **unclear**, or two pages **disagree**, this course says so.

Before module 01

- Have the study guide open once: it's the exam's contract with you.
- Keep paper beside you for the scenarios. Committing on paper is the point.
- An Azure subscription helps, but nothing here requires you to follow along live.
- Chapters are in the description: every module is a separate timestamp.
- Module 01 starts now, with the mental model everything else hangs from.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Nine hours and forty-six minutes. Most of the marks are in the decisions, so take the pauses seriously.